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trend-setting style statements

From YSL-inspired tuxedo suits to chiffon saris, from Babli kurtis to noodle-strap blouses, the heroines wore their style on their sleeves. The heroes were no less, with their bell-bottoms, goatees and hairstyles making waves.

1 Bell-bottoms

Towering above all his co-stars, Amitabh Bachchan sauntered into the '70s as did his flared bell-bottoms. Right from the smash hit *Zanjeer* (1973) to *Deewar* (1975) and *Parvarish* (1977), he wore the flower power favourite and made it his own. The high-waisted pants remained mono-toned but the shirts became floral (INDIA TODAY, July 2006).



5 Madame Rouge

As the '80s dawned, Rekha, in perfect make-up and svelte figure, arose like a phoenix. In *Silsila*, she paired her pastel saris with scarlet lip colours. Soon the lipsticks became deeper, the eye shadow golden and the fake eyelashes impossibly long. As the wronged woman

2 Pant Suits

Yves Saint Laurent (YSL) broke gender lines with his Le Smoking tuxedo pant suit for women in 1966. But in Bollywood, heroines ditched their nine yards for this runway favourite only in 1972. The beautiful Hema Malini put on her maroon pants and matching jacket, accessorised with a headband, strapped on skates in *Seeta Aur Geeta* (1972) to give androgyny a shot in the arm. The glamorous Zeenat Aman took it further, ditching her midis and maxis to wear the smart suits. Paired with a short crop in *Don* (1978), Aman as Roma cut a dangerously fashionable figure.



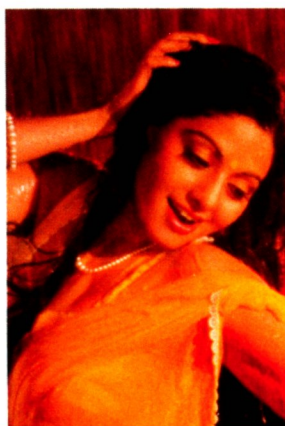
3 Disco Shirts

Rishi Kapoor immortalised Monty in *Karz* (1980), shimmering in his disco shirts and crooning *Om Shanti Om*; a jazzed-up cousin of Rajesh Khanna's kurti, popularised in *Andaz* (1971). His multicolour sweaters were the 'in' thing. A much older and pot-bellied Kapoor continued to pull off his sweater till *Bol Radha Bol* (1992). Sadly, not with the same effect.



4 Chiffon Saris

Yash Chopra's heroines, draped in chiffon and sashaying down the Alps, became the everlasting picture of Bollywood romance from Rekha in *Silsila* (1981) to Sridevi in *Chandni* (1989). Son Aditya followed suit and his Simran (Kajol) too was seen in a chiffon salwar-kameez in *Dilwale Dulhania Le Jayenge* (1995).



in *Khoon Bhari Mang* (1988), Rekha as Jyoti sent women to their nearest make-up counter for shades of maroon and scarlet. "Suddenly, women wanted everything matched down to the mole," says make-up artist Mickey Contractor.